



Tanzania Film Festival 2025

14th - 16th August

Prepared by
Studio 19 Limited

#TAFFA2025





Executive Summary

The Tanzania Film Festival (TAFFA 2025), held in collaboration with **the Mashariki Creative Economy Expo**, firmly positioned Tanzania as a dynamic hub for film, creativity, and cultural exchange. The Festival and Expo, took place at the Mlimani City, Dar es Salaam, the three-day event (14th - 16th August) marked a defining milestone for the nation's creative industries, bringing together diverse stakeholders from film, arts, culture and the broader creative economy.

Festival Highlights

- **Participation:** Over 1,600 attendees including filmmakers, industry professionals, cultural leaders, youth, and international guests.
- **Screenings:** More than 30 films from Tanzania and across Africa showcased the diversity and depth of regional storytelling.
- **Panels & Workshops:** 16+ sessions with 48 speakers, exploring themes of storytelling, digital transformation, financing, policy, and emerging technologies such as AI and VR.
- **Exhibitions:** The Expo and Festival brought together 60+ exhibitors, highlighting innovations across creative industries, from animation and music to design and media.

Prepared for
Studio 19 Limited

We are thankful to our various partners and sponsors





Pre Festival Activities

Pre - Festival Achievements

Leading up to the Tanzania Film Festival, a series of capacity-building activities, workshops, screenings, and dialogues were organized across Dar es Salaam. These programs not only built momentum but also empowered filmmakers, engaged communities, and amplified the visibility of the Festival.

Key Numbers at a Glance

- **Total Participants:** 545 (248 male, 225 female, 72 not recorded)
- **Number of Activities Held:** 15+ across diverse themes
- **Range of Formats:** Public launch, panels, workshops, screenings, school dialogues, and masterclasses
- **Facilitators & Partners:** 25+ experts including filmmakers, trainers, academics, and industry professionals

Highlights of the Build-Up

- **Skill-Building Workshops:**
 - **Scriptwriting Series** (9–17 July) trained over 50 participants with facilitators from Nafasi Film Club and Tanzania Scriptwriters Association.
 - Technical Training including a **Camera Masterclass, Set Design,** and **Stop Animation labs** attracted enthusiastic emerging creatives.
- **Thematic Engagements:**
 - **Finding Funds for Films** workshop tackled financing challenges.
 - **Film in Health** session bridged cinema and public health with medical and creative experts.
- **Community Impact:**
 - **Film Screening and Dialogue** at Kibasila Secondary School (25th July) reached 232 students, making it one of the most impactful sessions in terms of youth engagement.
- **Innovation & Storytelling:**
 - **Impact Film Lab** and Stop Animation Workshops introduced young talents to experimental and impactful storytelling methods.

Pre Festival Activities



2nd July

Public Launch

The session, held at the British Council, introduced our partners and program, while also engaging stakeholders on how they could take part in the Road to TAFFA. It was broadcast live by Azam, our main media sponsor.

Attendance **59**



3rd July

Panel on Directing The Future

A panel discussion with renowned film directors sharing their perspectives on the evolution of filming tools and techniques across music videos, films, series, and advertisements.

Panelists:

- Adam Juma,
- Edwin Musiba,
- Salum Majagi
- Sama Jahanpour (Moderator)

Attendance **30**

Partners

19 RENTALS

NAFASI
art space



8th July

Camera masterclass

The session explored different cameras, highlighting their strengths, limitations, and how shooting choices affect editing. It also covered editing tools, affordable options, and the need to meet international standards for broader markets

Facilitator:

- Steve Aanu

Attendance **14**

Partners

19 RENTALS

af Alliance Française
Dar Es Salaam

Pre Festival Activities



9th July

Finding Fund for films

Masterclass by filmmaker Amil Shivji trained mid- to advanced-level directors and producers in pitching skills. Ten projects joined; eight teams completed, and five successfully pitched their work during the festival

Facilitator

- Amil Shivji
- Cece Mlay

Attendance **16**

Partners



9th & 10th July

Script writing (From story to script)

A two parts beginner-friendly workshop that guided participants on how to transform their stories into scripts.

Facilitator

- Hafsa J Salum

Attendance **36**

Partners



12th July

Introduction to Stop Animation

A two-part, beginner-friendly workshop that introduced participants to stop motion animation. Working in groups, they created short animations using simple props.

Facilitator:

- Alphonse Haule
- Nsiie Uiso

Attendance **18**

Partners



Pre Festival Activities



16th & 17th July

Advanced Script writing

A two part masterclass for intermediate and advanced scriptwriters, providing an opportunity to refine their skills and learn from internationally acclaimed writers.

Facilitator

- Dr. Mona Mwakalinga
- Adbul Simba

Attendance **18**

Partners



18th July

Film Critique and Review

A workshop on film analysis and critique, encouraging participants to go beyond entertainment by examining, critiquing, and learning from films.

Facilitator

- Jesse Gerard Mpango

Attendance **17**

Partners



23rd July

Film in Health

A session of screenings and discussions on Film for Health and Behaviour Change, highlighting the power of film to educate, inspire, and creatively deliver health messages that directly impact communities.

Invited Speaker

- Cecilia Lubango
- George Msuya
- Lateefa- Lilian Chuwa
- Hasaan Kiyungi
- Everbright Everready

Attendance **27**

Partners



Pre Festival Activities



24th & 25th July

Set design workshop

A two-day workshop on set design, covering the importance of sets in film, aligning design with scripts, and creatively using everyday props.

Facilitator

- Catherine Michael

Attendance **24**

Partners



25th July

Film Screening and Dialogue Kibasila secondary school

A two parts beginner-friendly workshop that guided participants on how to transform their stories into scripts.

Facilitator

- Hafsa J Salum

Attendance **232**

Partners



31st July - 16th August

Impact Film Lab

The Impact Film Lab trained producers, directors, and scriptwriters on using film to inspire change and influence social outcomes. Two teams received training, mentorship, and equipment support, and produced two short films.

Facilitator / Mentors:

- Hassan Kiyungi
- Khatibu Madudu
- Amini Suwedi
- Sama Jahanpour

Attendance **24**

Partners



Festival Activities



Panels & Forums



Siri ya Mafanikio, kutengeneza tamhilia kali Nchini



Documentary Masterclass kutoka kwa Docubox



Mchango wa Filamu katika Agenda za Kitaifa



Akili Unde (AI) na Maendeleo ya Filamu



Kutana na Wasambazaji wa Filamu wakubwa Nchini



Pitching Session ya Filamu

Docubox Day



Docubox – The East African Documentary Film Fund is a regional institution dedicated to supporting independent filmmakers and strengthening the documentary film ecosystem. Its participation at TAFFA highlighted the role of documentary film in shaping narratives and amplifying diverse voices in East Africa.

The program featured two sessions:

1. **Documentary Masterclass** facilitated by filmmaker Cece Mlay, followed by a case study presented by Kelvin Kagambo. Both of whom are beneficiaries of the Docubox Fund. The sessions provided participants with practical knowledge on the art and craft of documentary filmmaking as well as insights drawn from local practice



2. **Shorts, Shorts & Shots (SSS)**, Docubox's signature event. The audience came dressed in shorts, to view and discuss short films from Africa, while sipping shots (both alcoholic & non alcoholic). The program featured short film screenings accompanied by Q&A sessions, alongside music performances, social interactions, and networking opportunities, creating a platform for engagement between filmmakers, stakeholders, and audiences.



Attendance

378

Performances from: Dj Seche and Malaika Tarumbeta Band

MCs : Faith Emmanuel, Gertrude Mbela Alphonse Haule

Exhibitions

The Mashariki Creative Economy Expo featured over 60 booths showcasing film, art centres, fashion, and publishing. It provided a platform for creatives to connect and explore collaborations, with notable stakeholders including the Tanzania Film Board, CRDB Bank (administrator of the Art Fund), and prominent film series such as Dunia also exhibited

HIGHLIGHTS



Screenings

Over 437 films were submitted through Film Freeway and Film Festival Portal (tuzo.taffafestival.or.tz/) . After a review process with the Film Board, 30 films were selected for screening during the three-day festival. Additionally,

SELECTED FILMS

Uhuru Wangu by Muddy Sule
FIDI by Gwamaka Mwabuka
What Do You Say? by Kelvin Kagambo
Nafasi (The chance) by Sudi Mohamedi Masomwa
Hatua by Jasmin Munguti
Mundu Mpepho (The wind man) by David Kalala
Mapito by Mikidadi Mwinyijuma Mwinyiamani
Special kid by ponsiano Jonathan Ngumbulu
My Friend by Gwantwa Lucas Mwakalinga
Astahafirullah by Khamis Abdullah Jabir
NGWALE THE FALLEN LEGACY SHORT FILM by Mark Maganja Mark
FAHARI by Jenifer Kyaka
Bunji - Nuru ya Kawetere by Ramar King (Isarito Mwakalindile)
Msichana by Flavia Mmbando
WONDARLAND by Matthieu Nieto
SITUATIONSHIP by Simon Cherehani
KOMBOLELA SERIES by Abdul Usanga
JIVU SERIES by Abdul Usanga
DUNIA by Issa Madinga Jumanne
ZAWADI by Tom John Johns
UBANDA by HAFIDH ABEID (D'ZONGA CARLITO)
MZANI by INNOCENT JOSEPH
KIWEMBE by MATHEWS JOSEPH MK
INZALA by ALBERT VENANCE BONIPHACE
CHEMLI by SELEMAN ALLY KIWAMBA
KONIKUNYUMBA by FELIX MAHUNDI STEPHANO
RANSOM by DANIEL EDWARD MALE
ENG'OKI by HAFIDH ABEID(D'ZONGA CARLITO)
BARALUKO by SALIM AHMEDY ISSA
BOBO by MAURICE MUENDO



Film Pitching

5 Previously trained producer-director team pitched their film projects and received feedback from a panel of judges.



MEZA SAWA

Team Members:

- Tyatawelu Emmanuel,
- Juma Saada



**NGONO KWA SAMAKI
(FISH FOR SEX)**

Team Members:

- Joseph Kirati,
- Shafii Hamis



UKUNGU (FOG)

Team Members:

- Doreen Kilimbe,
- Martha John



UDHURUNGI (BROWN)

Team Members:

- Abdallah Fuad,
- Amos Kini



**MY MOTHER'S STORY
NOT MINE**

Team Members:

- Diana Senetor Lyoto

Judges



**PETER MUDAMBA
MUDAMBA**

General Manager :
Docubox



GRACE MGAYA

Public Relations
Specialist:
Multichoice



**WASIWASI
MWAMBULAMBO**

Head of Concept
Development at
Azam TV



SARAH B. ATHANAS

Digital Services
Executive: Vodacom
Tanzania

Emcee



HAIKAELI GILLIARD

Program Lead, Studio19



Winner

**Best Pitch at
TAFZA 2025**

UKUNGU (FOG)

Team Members:

- Doreen Kilimbe,
- Martha John

Strategic Impact

The joint platform created by TAFFA and the Mashariki Expo demonstrated that Tanzania's creative industries are not just about entertainment—they are engines of economic growth, social cohesion, and cultural diplomacy.

Cross-Sector Synergies

The collaboration linked film, technology, fashion, design, and media, enabling creatives to explore new markets and collaborations. This synergy established Tanzania as a regional meeting point for diverse industries.

Business and Investment Opportunities

Through B2B engagements, networking sessions, and industry dialogues, the Festival opened doors for producers, distributors, investors, and entrepreneurs. Discussions on co-productions, distribution platforms, and financing models laid the foundation for more sustainable creative enterprises.

Cultural Diplomacy & Regional Leadership

Hosting participants from across Africa and beyond, the Festival amplified Tanzania's profile as a leader in storytelling and creative innovation, reinforcing cultural ties and positioning Dar es Salaam as a gateway for regional collaboration.

Youth and Talent Empowerment

Young filmmakers, emerging artists, and creative entrepreneurs found mentorship, exposure, and practical opportunities. By spotlighting new voices, the Festival nurtured a pipeline of talent ready to contribute to the nation's creative economy.

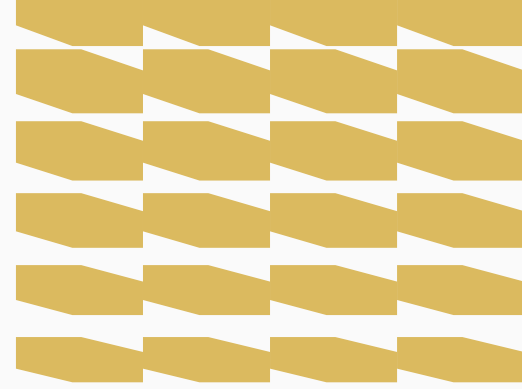


Looking Ahead

The success of this year's Festival and Expo sets the stage for sustained impact:

- Building momentum toward the **Tanzania Film Awards in December 2025**, which will recognize excellence in storytelling.
- Establishing strategic partnerships with local and international institutions to **expand training, funding, and distribution opportunities** for filmmakers.
- Positioning Tanzania as a regional leader in the creative economy, leveraging film as a driver of both cultural identity and economic growth.

Together, the Tanzania Film Festival and the Mashariki Creative Economy Expo have created not just an event, but a movement one that celebrates creativity, unlocks opportunities, and advances the role of storytelling and culture in shaping Tanzania's future.



Join the Movement

We warmly invite sponsors, partners, and collaborators to join us on this journey as we:

- Expand opportunities for Tanzanian and African filmmakers.
- Strengthen the creative economy as a driver of growth and innovation.
- Build enduring cultural connections that showcase Tanzania on the global stage.

By walking with us, you are not only supporting an event you are shaping a movement that transforms stories into engines of progress.

Let's create lasting impact together.



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www.taffafestival.or.tz

